OHIO HIGH SCHOOL ATHLETIC ASSOCIATION

2023 & 2024 Approved Baseball Officiating Mechanics, Regulations & Standards

"The Blue Book"

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"One of the really wrong theories about officiating is that a good official is one you never notice. The umpire who made that statement was probably a real poor official who tried to get his paycheck and hide behind his partners and stay out of trouble all his life. Control of the ballgame is the difference between umpires that show up for the players and the managers." - National League Umpire Bruce Froemming

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Introduction

Very few issues that arise during a baseball game are rules related. (This not to say that a thorough understanding of the rules is not necessary, it's required!) Most however, can be linked to umpire mechanics. There are holes in 2-umpire mechanics no matter how good you are or how long you have been officiating.

Prior to each season, it is always a good idea to refresh yourself on the with our two person mechanics. Even though not much has changed we can fall into bad habits during the summer months when its 90 plus degrees!

Three and four-umpire mechanics help reduce the holes in officiating but at a cost. The mechanics in this manual help minimize those gaps but in no way will be able to eliminate them. Experience, training and general baseball knowledge help us overcome those hurdles that arise during the game.

The two-umpire mechanics has not changed from 2021-2022 issue. The feedback from our umpires has been very favorable to the previous changes and I see no need to mess with something that is working.

This manual will only have the two-umpire system included. The sheer size of the three and four-umpire mechanics makes it impossible to print and mail out. All three mechanic illustrations will be on OHSAA.org under the DOD web page.

One issue that continues to be a problem is tobacco. Yes, tobacco, by a coaches, players and officials. No tobacco is a rule for all those participating which includes us. Schools are tobacco free and that means in the parking lots!

I would like to give special thanks to Frank Grubb, Jon Saphire, Mark Kuhn, Mike Dame, Anthony Sheets and Daniel McGinnis for their help in putting this manual together. We needed to make sure that any changes that were made could be performed by all levels of officiating and made sense.

General Umpire Mechanics

Having read numerous baseball umpire manuals one thing became evident. There is a lot of mechanics that we have passed down that are not written in any manual. We all watch baseball both live and on TV but do we really take note of the little things that make for good umpiring.

A few years ago, after the third week of new umpire class, I asked the class to watch the umpires carefully and I would ask them some questions the following class. They had already begun reading the NFHS Mechanics Manual and had been working on the rules. What I found was quite interesting and started me thinking about how to address this in OHSAA.

Here are a few of the questions I asked the class after they watched a professional game on TV. What hand did the umpire take his mask off with? What hand did the plate umpire carry his indicator? Did the umpire put the ball in play after a foul ball? …….

There are many aspects that we have learned that were passed down from veteran umpires that need to be written down so that we are all on the same page. So here we go:

- Always clean your shoes prior to each game
- Once you enter the confines of the field, never lay your mask down, hang it on a fence or put it on the bench.
- When there is a pop up that the catcher is fielding, the plate umpire should keep his mask on until the catcher throws his.
- The plate umpire should clean the plate off with the brush before each half inning with his butt facing the pitching mound.
- Plate gear to be worn under your uniform
- Always take the mask off with your left hand.
- Carry your indicator in your left hand
- Appeal with your left hand. "Did he go?"
- Both umpires wear their hat with the bill facing forward at all times.
- Base umpires do not carry plate brushes or wear ball bags.
- During defensive conferences, the base umpire should go to the outfield
- During pitching changes, the base umpire should count the pitches and tell the plate umpire (non-verbally) when they have had 5 warmups.
- Partners should meet during a game only if it is important and never right after a controversial call.
- Always walk on and off the field with your partner.
- Always put the ball in play after it has been declared dead.
- Keep track of both defensive and offensive conferences.
- Do not point to first base with right hand to award a base

Veteran umpires will laugh at many of the above items but take it from me, I have seen many if not all of them in practice. If you can think of any other unwritten mechanics issues, please send them to me and I will add them to the list.

Officiating Code of Ethics

- Must devote time, thought and study to the rules of the game and the mechanics necessary to carry out these rules so that one may render effective and creditable service in a fair and unbiased manner.
- Must work with fellow officials and the state association in a spirit of harmony and cooperation in spite of differences of opinion that may arise during debate of issues.
- Must resist every temptation and outside pressure to use one's position as an official to benefit oneself. Under all circumstances, officials must avoid promoting the special interest of any person or group of persons other than the athletes we serve.
- Must constantly uphold the honor and dignity of the officiating industry in all personal conduct and relations with student-athletes, coaches, athletic directors, school administrator, colleagues and the public, to be worthy example of the athletes under one's jurisdiction.
- Be prepared both physically and mentally, dressed according to expectations of sport standards, and maintain a proper appearance that is befitting the importance of the game.
- Avoid the use of tobacco and tobacco products at the contest site.
- Shall not consumer alcohol (or any illegal/illicit drug or controlled substance) prior to or during the game.
- Must remember and recognize that it is important to honor contracts regardless of possible inconvenience or financial loss. Every member to the officiating profession carries a responsibility to act in a manner becoming a professional person. The conduct of any official influences the attitude of the public toward the profession in general as well as toward the official in particular.

Required Uniform

- Gray pants (either Heather Gray or Charcoal) for the regular season, sectional and district tournament. For regional and state games, Charcoal Gray pants are required. All umpires on a crew for any regular or post season games are to be dressed alike.
- MLU navy shirt with the OHSAA embroidered or sublimated logo. If you wear a short sleeve MLU shirt, it **is not permissible to wear a long sleeve garment under it.**
- Undershirts or t-shirts shall be red.
- Black socks are to be worn.
- Predominately black plate or base shoes with black laces.
- Black leather belt 1 ½ to 2 inches wide with plain buckle.
- Navy cap with the OHSAA logo embroidered on the crown.
- The jacket shall be the "red shoulder stripe" model. Navy with red/white trim on the shoulder. The OHSAA logo shall be properly placed on the jacket.
- No other logos, patches, emblems, or numbers are permitted on the official uniform. An American Flag patch/emblem is optional and if worn it is to be on the left sleeve with the star field facing to the front.
- No Jewelry except wedding band or medical alert necklaces or bracelets. A religious medallion which is not visible is permitted. A watch is permitted only if an official has a duty for timing during the contest.
- All umpires on a crew are to dress alike.
- The plate umpire shall wear all protective equipment as specified by rule (plate shoes are required). Dark blue or gray ball bags shall be used.

General Reminders

- Each year go over the rule and casebook and note any changes for that year.
- Make note of any mechanics changes.
- You get one chance at first impressions. Make sure that your uniform is in good order and that you have cleaned or polished your shoes before each game. Hats do wear out and need to be replaced from time to time.
- A good month prior to the season, try on all your gear. This will allow you time to have either new gear purchased, or alterations made.
- Chest protectors need to be snug up under your chin. The collar bone needs to be covered at all times and this adjustment should be made prior to the first pitch. During the game, the protector should not be shifting, if it is, tighten it up.
- The shoes we wear are crucial. For the plate we are required to have hard toed shoes with metatarsal protection. Both plate and base shoes need to have golf type spikes or a ripple bottom for traction.
- One or both umpires should carry an indicator.
- Do not carry a plate brush when doing the bases.

Game Day Procedures

- Verify with the home school the start time, location, and any accommodations they may have (locker room!).
- Arrive approximately 30 minutes prior to start time. Notify game management that you have arrived.
- Examine the playing field closely, making sure that it is properly marked, the pitcher's plate is legal and familiarize yourself with the boundaries.
- Coordinate with your partner where to meet. If dressing in the parking lot, try to do so away from other cars and remember there are laws we must follow.
- Once you have decided who is working where, go through a pre-game so that you are on the same page. Make note of any special issues that this field might present.
- Walk up to the field together and arrive at the plate approximately 5 minutes prior to the start time.

Pregame

- Five minutes prior to the start of the game meet with both head coaches at the plate.
- The plate umpire is standing at the point of the plate facing the pitching mound.
- The base umpire is standing directly across from the plate umpire facing the back stop.
- Both umpires are to introduce themselves to the coaches and any captains.
- Plate umpire is to check the home team lineup first followed by the visiting team. Make note of any DH on the card and verify that is what they're using.
- Ask both coaches if all players are legally and properly equipped and that all equipment is legal. Both coaches must answer "yes". If they don't know then they need to verify and respond "yes".
- Share your expectations about exhibiting good sportsmanship. During the game, if they have a question, you are more than willing to answer them. Not long distance!
- Ask the home team coach to take you around the diamond starting at the back stop. They need to explain the boundaries and any local rules that need to apply. If you don't agree or don't understand, now is the time to get it straightened out.
- Once conference is over, if there is a national anthem, the base umpire should stand at the right of the plate umpire (two man) behind the plate.
- At the conclusion of the meeting, the base umpire is to jog down the baseline into the outfield.
- Now is a good time to get ready for the game, the plate umpire should take 6 or so pitches behind the catcher and the base umpire should watch the throws from the infield to first base.

During the game

- The plate umpire is designated as the umpire-in-chief and is responsible for announcing "Play" and giving the hand signal to start the game or resume play.
- The umpire-in-chief shall determine if lights are to be turned on and this should be done prior to the start of an inning.
- With no runners on base, the base umpire shall position himself 10-12 feet behind the first baseman with both feet in foul territory. (Right foot next to the foul line)
- If a fly ball is hit to an area in the outfield that the base umpire is responsible for and is deemed a trouble ball, he will go out to rule on fair/foul and catch/no catch.

- A trouble ball is
    - Fair/foul decision down the right field line.
    - Home runs.
    - Balls off the wall.
    - Diving catches by the outfielder.
    - Catches with the fielder running to the wall.
    - Catches below the waist.
    - Players converging on a fly ball.

- The base umpire will communicate with his partner "I'm going out" and the plate umpire now has the batter-runner. **NOTE: Pause, Read, and React – then BE DECISIVE! Decide to go out or come in and stick to it. Indecision puts both umpires at a disadvantage. Suddenly nobody gets a good look at a ball/play that can require the most attention.**
- The base umpire will get the best angle and be completely stopped when there is a play made or fair/foul decision.
- The plate has all bounding balls up to third and first base. If the base umpire is stationed at that base, then he will have the ruling on fair/foul once it passes the front edge of that base.
- Any umpire may call a balk and/or signal a delayed dead ball or call time.
- Be completely stopped prior to any play being made. Your head is like a camera if the head moves so does the lenses.
- Always strive to get the best angle when making a call. Too close and everything blends together and distorts your vision. Too far and you don't seem credible.
- If you have the proper angle and distance, then your eyes will lead to proper timing and judgement.
- **There are no rotations if the batted ball does not leave the infield. Base umpire has all bases.**
- **Get the call right:** A call needs to be made on every play. When a coach asks if the calling umpire can get help, you need to get together (no coaches or players around) and discuss what you have. The emphasis is put on getting together and discussing. It is still up to the calling umpire to make the final decision on the call and can use the information from the other umpire in making the final decision. In years past, we used to point to the other umpire and ask what he has! It looks really silly when he says, "I have nothing". Once you have the decision the calling umpire makes the call and if a coach wants to discuss, politely tell him what you have, and the discussion is over.

Plate Umpire

- The important parts of the job are your stance, tracking the pitch, calling it a ball or strike, using the indicator and finally plays at the plate.
- The three plate stances are, The Box, the Scissors, and the Knee. You need to find the one that works best for you, but we recommend the Box and will discuss this stance.
    - Feet are spread slightly more than shoulder width apart and placed in a heel-toe configuration, with the slot foot (left foot for a right-handed batter) slightly ahead of your back foot and your weight evenly distributed on the balls of your feet. Your hands for a right-handed batter, your right hand is on your right knee helping you feel locked in, your left hand can be behind your thigh or tucked so that your left elbow is on your thigh and your hand is between your legs.
    - No matter which plate stance you use your head height should be the same. Your chin should be at the top of the catcher's head.
    - Positioning behind the catcher should also be the same. The ideal location is the "slot". The slot is the area between the batter and the catcher. By being in this area you have a good view of the entire plate and if your head height is correct, you have a good view of the down and out pitch. A good starting point for getting into the slot is (for a right-handed batter) to place your right foot in the middle of the catcher's body, swing your left foot toward the catcher about shoulder width and slightly ahead of the right foot. Adjust your height by spreading your feet.
- Tracking the pitch
    - From the moment the pitcher releases a pitch until the ball arrives in the catcher's mitt, your head should remain still.
    - Track the pitch with your eyes only, all the way into the mitt. You might hear someone say you have tunnel vision or you're not tracking the ball all the way in. We tend to track the ball until about 3 feet in front of the plate and with breaking balls this will cause you to miss a lot of good pitches.
    - Visualize the strike zone on each batter. A good rule of thumb is if a pitch comes across the plate below the front elbow of the batter, then it is at the top of the strike zone.
- Calling the pitch
    - Timing is critical on the pitched ball. Watch the ball with your eyes all the way into the mitt and watch the catcher catch the ball. Quickly replay the pitch in your mind to make sure that you saw what you saw and then make the call.
    - If the pitch did not cross through any part of the strike zone and the batter did not swing, it is a ball. To **call a ball**, remain in your stance and call, "Ball". The call should be loud enough for the pitcher, catcher, and batter to hear. After you made the call, you should come out of your stance.
    - If the pitch did cross through any part of the strike zone and the batter did not swing, it is a called strike. To call a strike, stand straight up out of your stance and call "Strike". With the calling of strike an arm movement is required. It can be the hammer (like you are

calling an out) or pointing out to the side. If you go out to the side, make sure that your eyes stay on the playing field and not follow your finger. **Tip: If you're a "pointer" and**

struggle keeping your eyes forward, try pointing towards the dugout. This will help keep your head and eyes forward.

- It is a good habit to give the count on a regular basis. One idea is to give the count after the 3, 5, 7…pitch. Your left hand is the balls, and the right hand is the strikes. Make sure that you are using your indicator (in your left hand) to keep tabs on the count. Do not rely in the scoreboard to be correct!
- If a batter swings at a pitch, there is no need to call a strike. Do not call the obvious. Foul balls going directly over the backstop, to the backstop or dugout do not need to be called foul. Everyone knows it.
- If a batted ball hits the batter who is in the batter's box, call time and rule it a foul ball.
- Call 'em, don't explain 'em. Your pitch calling is not to be routinely explained, such as, "Ball Low"," Ball Inside" or "strike caught the corner".

- The mask is to be removed by the left hand and kept there during the play. The mask should be snug but also adjusted in order to remove the mask without having your hat come off. With your left hand (which also has the indicator in it) grab the bottom of the mask, pull down and out and then up. This takes a bit of practice and a plate hat that is snuggly fit.
- Clean the plate off with your plate brush, your butt facing the pitching mound and your mask in your left hand. Whenever the plate gets dirty, call time, and clean it off. Always clean the plate before the start of a half inning. If the coach asks for time to talk to his pitcher, here is another good time to clean the plate off after noting the conference on your line-up card.

GAME DAY MEETING

I. ARRIVAL AT THE GAME SITE:

a. Arrive at least 30 minutes prior to game time
b. Upon arrival notify game management and confirm starting time.
c. Ask who is the "Official" site administrator and where they'll be located. If no "official" site administrator, the Head Coach is considered the administrator.

II. PREGAME WITH PARTNER: DISCUSSION TOPICS (2-MAN MECHANICS)

a. Fair / Foul
   i. Bases empty – PU has left field line, and all bounding ball between home and first base (up to bag)
   ii. w/runner – PU has all fair / foul calls
b. Outfield Fly Balls
   i. Bases empty – PU takes all routine fly balls: talk about ball to right
   ii. w/runner – PU has the lines and left/right fielder moving towards the foul lines: base umpire has all the fly balls in the "V".
c. Infield Flies / Line Drives – discuss with partner
   i. Bases empty – split the field in half
   ii. w/runner – BU takes all except down the lines
d. Tag-Ups / Base Touches – keep it simple

i. PU take home and third (help @ first)
ii. BU take first and second
iii. Communicate if there is going to be an appeal

e. Calls at Third Base – **BIGGEST POTENTIAL FOR SCREW UPS** – discuss all potentials
i. Bases empty-Batter/Runner goes for triple
ii. Runner on second tries for third after throw to first on Batter/Runner
iii. Runner tags at second
iv. Runner from first goes to third on a base hit
v. Pitcher's pick-off throw at second goes into center field.

f. Check Swing – discuss with partner
i. PU ump asks- "Did he go?" and point at BU with open left hand.
ii. BU answer- "YES he did!" with the OUT signal or "NO he didn't!" with the SAFE signal
iii. Potential check swing/dropped third strike

g. Dropped Third Strike – discuss with partner on signal used
i. BU Fist clenched – catch
ii. BU Open hand – no catch (trap)

h. Batted Ball Hits Batter
i. First thing is to kill the play – "DEAD BALL!"
ii. Second thing to determine if batter was hit in the box (foul ball) or out of the box (out)

i. Getting Help
i. On what plays – check swing, possible pulled foot/swipe tag
ii. When? Ask after you make the call

j. Signals
i. Infield Fly
ii. Time play
iii. Outs/count
iv. Rotations
v. Umpire going out

k. Positioning
i. During anthem, between innings
ii. PU help insure proper positioning of BU prior to pitch

l. Arguments
i. When to get involved as a partner
ii. Keep it one-on-one

m. Rundowns
i. Who is going to be, where
ii. Need both ends of the play covered

n. Interference/Obstruction – how to handle

o. General
i. After dead ball – verbally put the ball back in play and point to the pitcher.
ii. **COMMUNICATE! COMMUNICATE! COMMUNICATE!** – "I've got the ball", "I'm at third" etc…
iii. Mirror your partner on infield fly, time, balk

III. ARRIVAL AT THE FIELD (DIAMOND) – 10 MINUTES BEFORE THE GAME

a. Umpire jurisdiction begins

b. Examine playing field as a crew for potential dead ball obstacles, safety concerns, etc…

IV. PREGAME W/COACHES AND/OR CAPTAINS – 5 MINUTES BEFORE THE GAME

a. Meet at home plate to check line-ups (home team first); permit inspection by coach/captain before line-ups become official (when PU receives)

b. Home team coach will decide whether the grounds and other conditions are suitable for starting the game: discuss ground rules; (home team); if visiting team agrees these shall be in force. If teams cannot agree, umpires shall formulate ground rules.

c. Discuss any other matters pertinent to the game: i.e. DH's, time limit, run-rule, speed-up rules, etc…

d. Ask coaches whether all their players are legally and properly equipped. (Jewelry?)

e. Provide copies of the official line-ups to the official scorer

f. Briefly discuss w/official scorer such matters as the proper batting order, appearance of pinch runners/hitters and substitutes.

g. **Ask the home team coach, "who is game management"? if he says there is no one, then he is it.**

V. GAME TIME

a. PU check to make sure BU ready

b. Game begins when PU calls **"PLAY!"**

Base Runners	**Position**	**Number of Outs**	**Hand Signals**
None	A	0,1,2	NONE
First	B	0,1,2	Number of Outs & Normal Rotation
First and Third	B	0,1,2	Number of Outs & Normal Rotation
First and Second	C	0,1	Number of Outs, Infield Fly, **Caught fly ball to OF-Plate Umpire has play at third** (unless fly ball is down RF foul line)
First and Second	C	2	Number of Outs, Timing Play, Plate Umpire Staying home
Second and Third	C	0,1	Number of Outs, Plate Umpire Staying home
Second and Third	C	2	Number of Outs, Timing Play, Plate Umpire Staying home
First, Second, Third	C	0,1	Number of Outs, Infield Fly, Plate Umpire Staying home
First, Second, Third	C	2	Number of Outs, Timing Play, Plate Umpire Staying home
Second Only	C	0,1	Number of Outs, Plate Umpire Staying home
Second Only	C	2	Number of Outs, Timing Play, Plate Umpire Staying home
Third Only	C	0,1,2	Number of Outs, Plate stays home (S16)

Hand Signals

Number of outs- Given with either right or left hand out to the side for partner to see

Normal Rotation- Hang Ten/Hang Loose sign, thumb and pinkie extended, move wrist back and forth

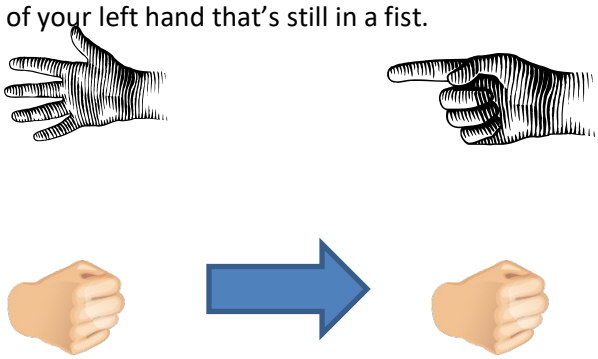
Infield Fly- Give the number of outs at the front of bill of cap, fist for 0 outs, index finger for 1 out

Timing Play- Index finger of right-hand point and touch left wrist (where a wrist watch would be worn)

Plate Umpire Staying home- point with both hands straight down

Caught Fly Ball to OF- **Baseman Signal**- Make a fist with right hand, tap the top of the fist with the palm of left hand, move up and down once or twice. Then point with index finger of left hand to third base, tapping the top of your right hand that's still in a fist.

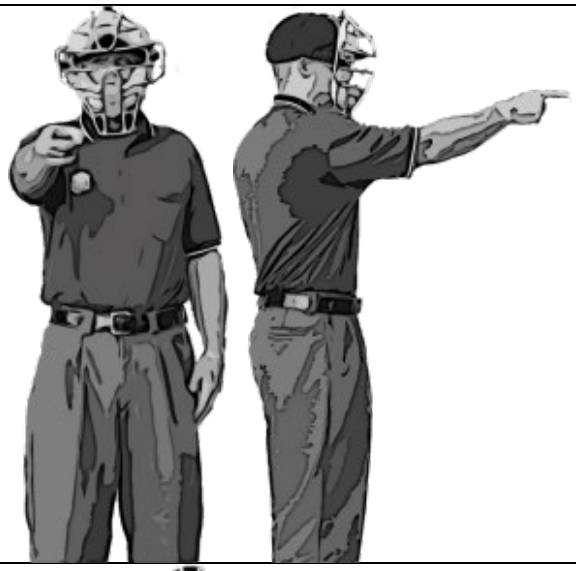
Caught Fly Ball to OF- **Plate Umpire Signal**- Make a fist with left hand, tap the top of the fist with the palm of right hand, move up and down once or twice. Then point with index finger of right hand to third base, tapping the top of your left hand that's still in a fist.



Approved OHSAA Baseball Signal Chart

Play (S1)

Description:
Pointing with right hand toward the pitcher and say "Play." Ball is now live.



Do Not Pitch (S2)

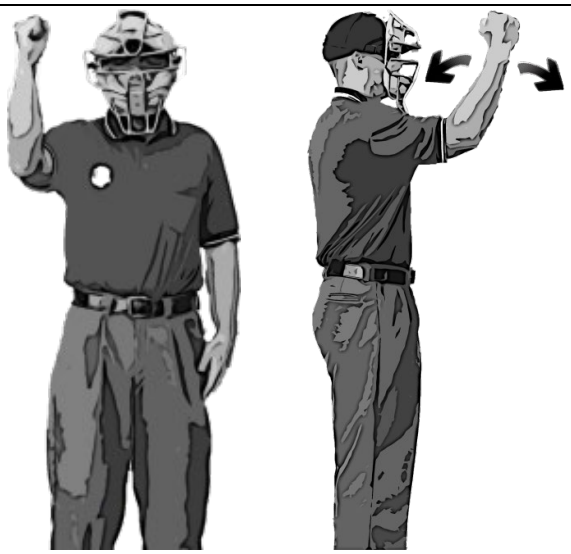
Description:
Hold right hand in front of our body with palm facing out. Ball is dead and must be put back in play (S13).

Foul ball, Time Out, Dead Ball (S3)

Description:
Both hands open above the head. Ball is dead immediately.

Strike (S4)

Description:
Stand straight up, bring your right hand up in front of your body, make a fist and say “strike”



Foul Tip (S5)

Description:
Stand upright and pass right hand over the left hand signifying foul tip. Ball is still live.

Count (S6)

Description:
Left hand is balls, right hand strikes. Hold both hand up in front of your body slightly above the shoulders. Signal should be forward towards pitcher and verbalized loud enough for Catcher, Batter & Pitcher.

Safe/Uncaught 3rd Strike (S7)

Description:
Start with your arms extended directly in front of your body and swing them open at shoulder height.

Appeal on Check Swing (8)

Description:
Step out from behind the catcher, extend your left arm, palm up and ask the base umpire "Did He Go?"

Safe /Did Not Go(S9)

Description:
Start with your arms extended directly in front of your body and swing them open at shoulder height. Used to signal that batter did not go when plate umpire asks "Did he go".

Out (S10)

Description:
Bring your right arm up, make a 90 degree angle, make a fist and with hammering action call, “He’s out”

Infield Fly (S11)

Description:
Once the ball has reached its Apex and you determine it is an infield fly, point your right hand toward ball and say “Infield Fly, batter is out”. If it is close to the foul line say “Infield Fly if Fair.”

Non-verbal communication (Pre-pitch)

Infield Fly (S12)

Description:

Right hand to the bill of the cap, number of outs may be given with this signal.

Timing Play (S13)

Description:

Place two fingers of the right hand on the left wrist. This signal will only be used in two-out situations where a time play involving a potential run is likely.

Standard Rotation (S14)

Description:

Thumb and pinkie fingers extended, arms down at side, rotate hands forward and backward.

Plate covers 3rd on caught fly ball to outfield (S15)

Description:

Used with infield fly (S12) and runners on 1st & 2nd only. Make fist with right hand, cover fist with left had fingers pointing to 3rd (S15).

Stay Home (S16)

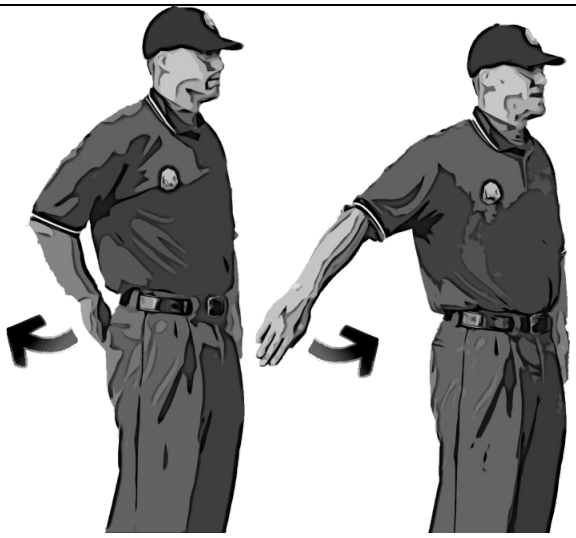
Description:

Point both arms straight down. Used when plate umpire should stay home.

Push (S17)

Description:

Used in 3 and 4 person mechanics. Move right hand behind the back letting other base umpire that this is a push situation. Umpire in C position should use left hand so umpire in A can see his signal.



Ohio High School Athletic Association

2 Umpire Mechanics

U1 IN POSITION A

Fair/Foul Responsibilities

- Plate – Up to the front edge of 1st base bag, and all the way to the foul pole up the 3rd baseline.
- U1 – Passed the front edge of 1st base bag to the foul pole.

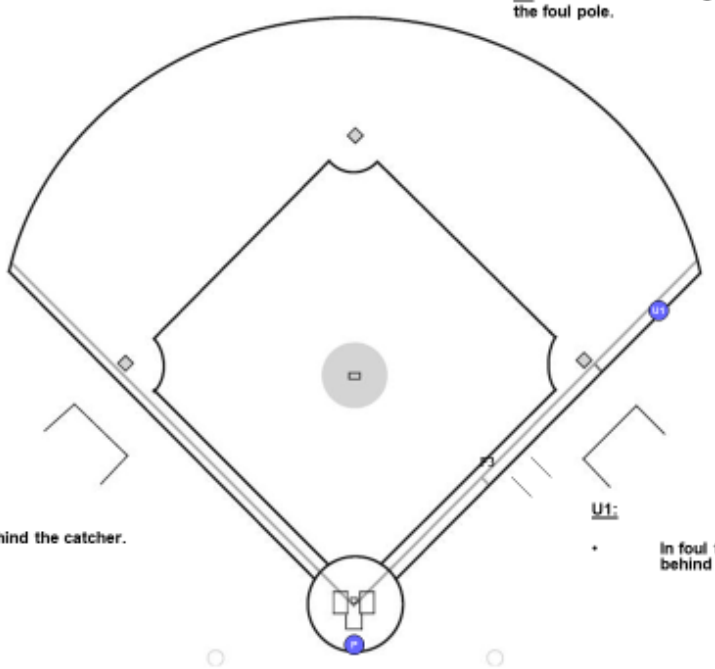


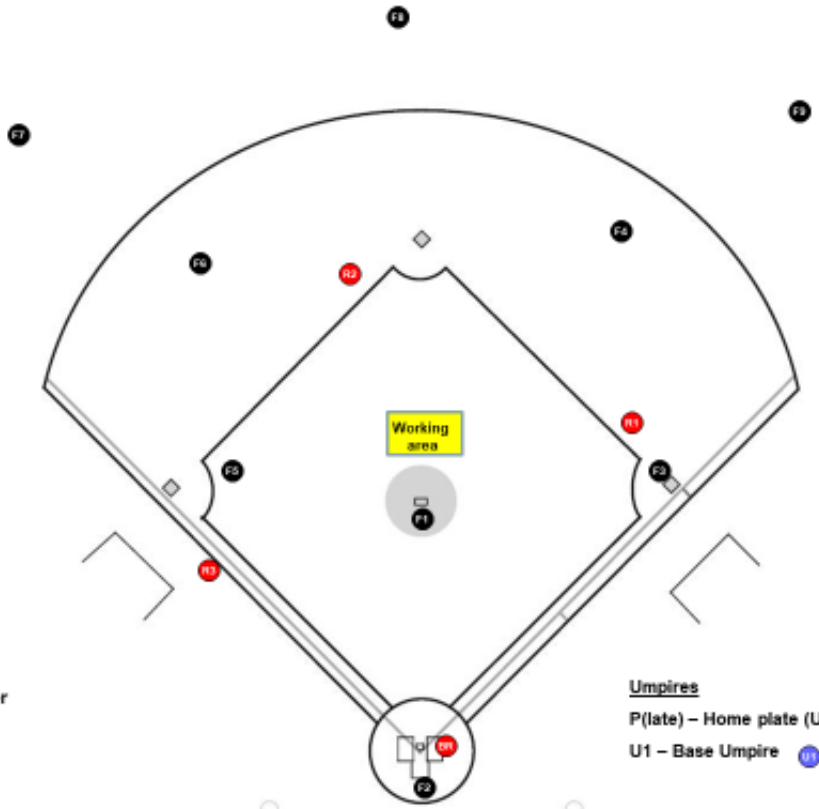
PLATE:

- Behind the catcher.

U1:

- In foul territory 10 feet behind F3.

ABBREVIATIONS



Defense

F1 – Pitcher

F2 – Catcher

F3 – 1st Baseman

F4 – 2nd Baseman

F5 – 3rd Baseman

F6 –Shortstop

F7 – Left Fielder

F8 – Center Fielder

F9 – Right Fielder

Offense

R1 –Runner on First

R2 –Runner on Second

R3 – Runner on Third

BR – Batter-Runner

Umpires

P(late) – Home plate (Umpire-in-Chief)

U1 – Base Umpire

FLY BALL OR LINE DRIVE TO RIGHT FIELD

Pause Read React

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

Pause, Read, React

- *Pause- open up toward the ball*
  Read- focus on fielder(s)
- *React- if you see trouble, go out.*

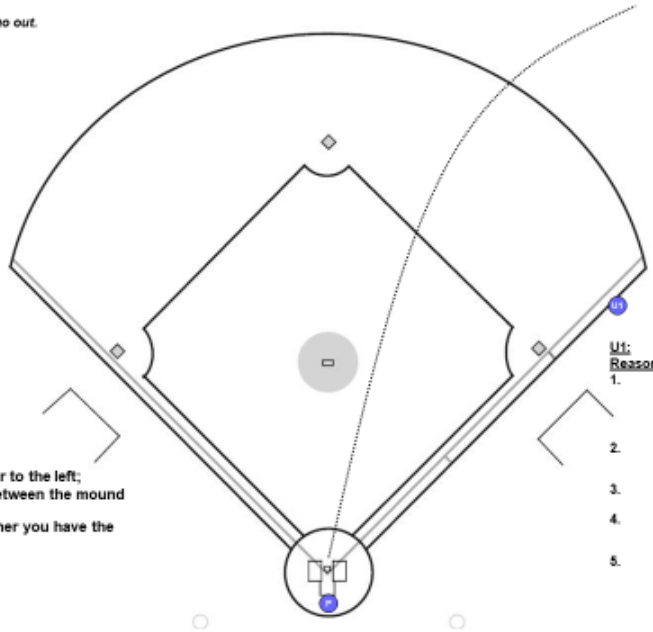


Plate:

- Always clear catcher to the left;
- Move in direction between the mound and first base;
- Read U1 as to whether you have the ball or the runner.

U1:
Reasons to go out:

1. F8 or F9 are running hard in towards the infield as if to make the catch on the dead run or dive to make the catch;
2. F8 or F9 turn their back to the infield and move towards the outfield wall;
3. F8, F9, and a infielder are converging on the ball;
4. F9 is running toward the foul line and a fair/foul decision may be needed;
5. Infielders are going back on the ball and it could possibly be a diving catch.

FLY BALL/LINE DRIVE RESPONSIBILITIES

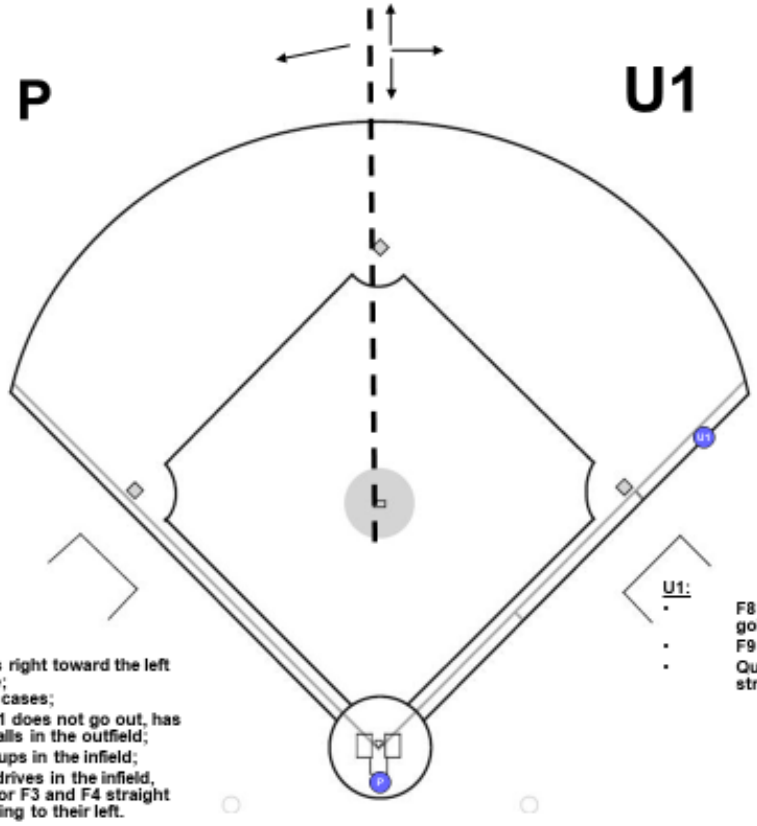


PLATE:

- F8 to his right toward the left field line;
- F7 in all cases;
- When U1 does not go out, has all the calls in the outfield;
- All pop-ups in the infield;
- All line-drives in the infield, except for F3 and F4 straight in or diving to their left.

U1:

- F8 coming in, going back, and going toward the right field line;
- F9 in all cases;
- Quick line drives to F3 and F4 straight in or diving to their left.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL OR LINE DRIVE TO RIGHT FIELD

U1 DOES NOT GO OUT

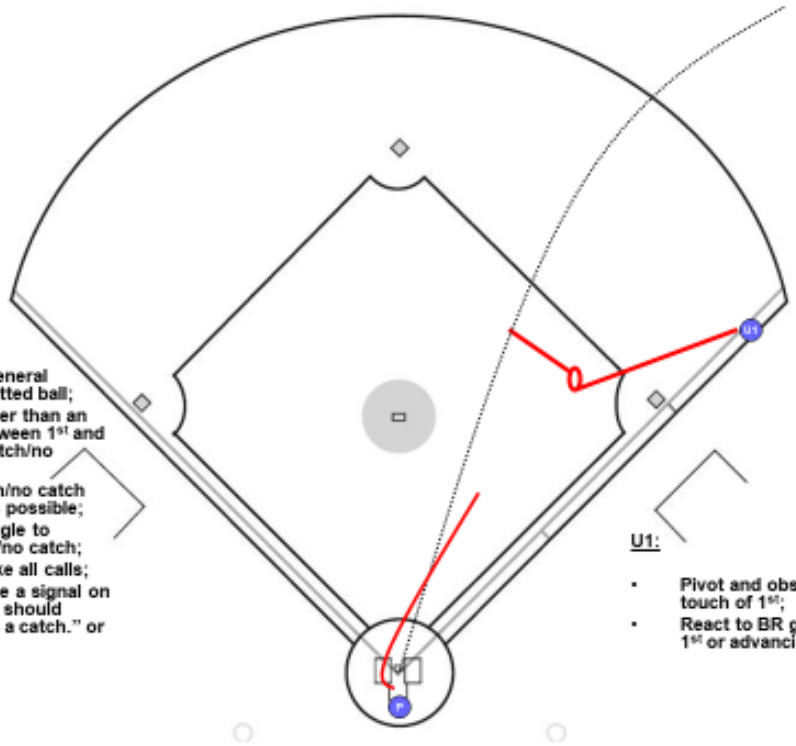


PLATE:

- Come out in the general direction of the batted ball;
- Come out no further than an imaginary line between 1st and 3rd on a routine catch/no catch;
- On a difficult catch/no catch move out as far as possible;
- Obtain the best angle to observe the catch/no catch;
- Be stopped to make all calls;
- Do not need to give a signal on a routine play, but should inform U1, "That's a catch." or "Ball's down.";

U1:

- Pivot and observe the BR's touch of 1st;
- React to BR going back into 1st or advancing to 2nd.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL OR LINE DRIVE TO RIGHT FIELD

U1 GOES OUT

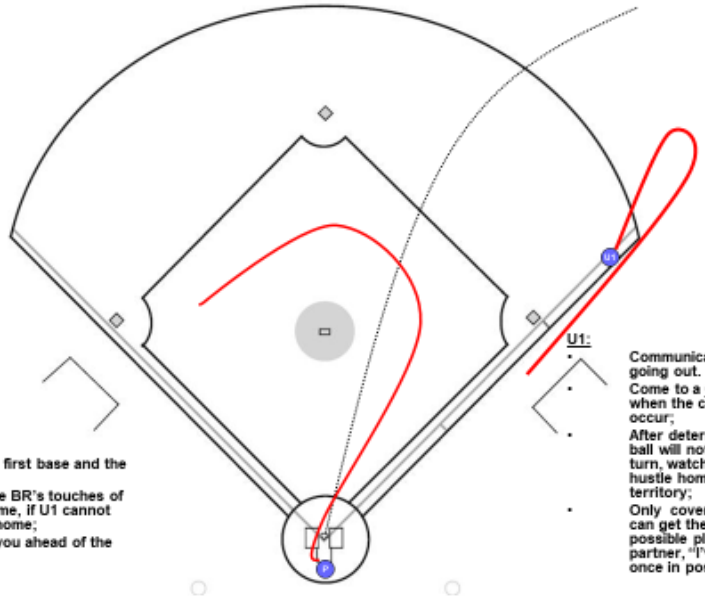


PLATE:

- Come out between first base and the mound;
- Responsible for the BR's touches of 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and home, if U1 cannot get back to cover home;
- Path should keep you ahead of the BR.

U1:

- Communicate that you're going out.
- Come to a COMPLETE stop when the catch is about to occur;
- After determining that the ball will not go out-of-play, turn, watching the ball, and hustle home in foul territory;
- Only cover the plate if you can get there prior to a possible play. Inform your partner, "I've got home!" once in position.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL OR LINE DRIVE TO LEFT FIELD

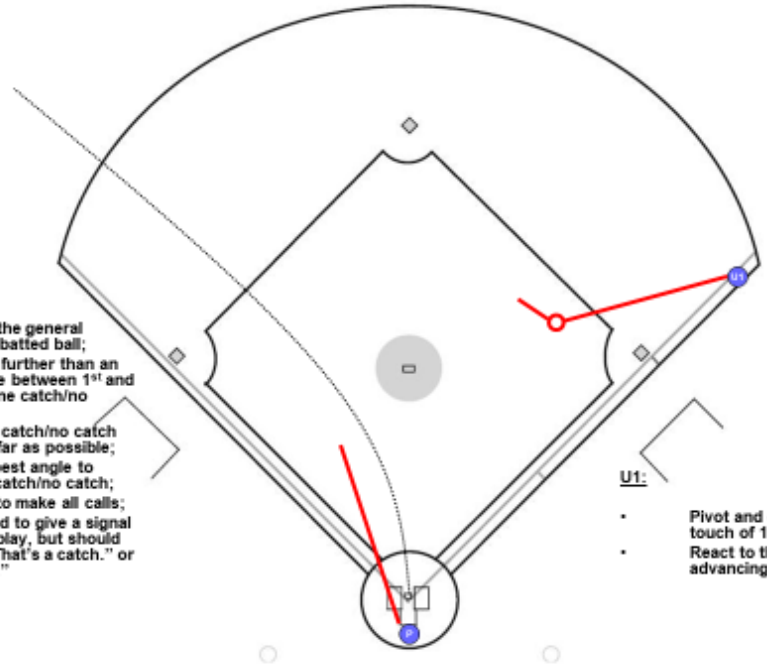


PLATE:

- Come out in the general direction the batted ball;
- Come out no further than an imaginary line between 1st and 3rd on a routine catch/no catch;
- On a difficult catch/no catch move out as far as possible;
- Obtains the best angle to observe the catch/no catch;
- Be stopped to make all calls;
- Does not need to give a signal on a routine play, but should inform U1, "That's a catch." or "Ball's down."

U1:

- Pivot and observe the BR's touch of 1st;
- React to the BR back into 1st or advancing to 2nd.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

POPUP ON THE INFIELD

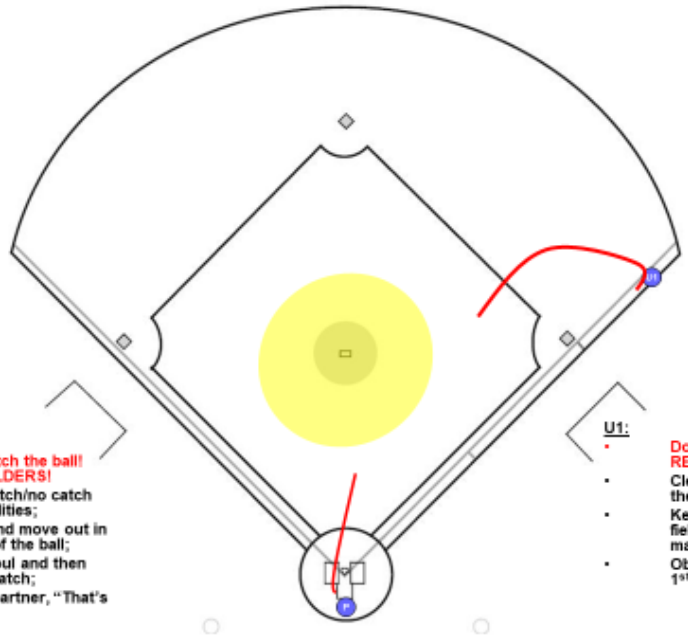


Plate:

- Do not watch the ball! READ FIELDERS!
- Take all catch/no catch responsibilities;
- Clear F2 and move out in direction of the ball;
- Rule fair/foul and then catch/no catch;
- Tell your partner, "That's a catch."

U1:

- Do not watch the ball! READ FIELDERS!
- Clear F3 and move into the infield;
- Keep distance from fielder(s) that are making a play;
- Observe BR's touch of 1st.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FOUL POP-UP BETWEEN HOME AND 1ST

BOTH F2 AND F3 GO FOR THE BALL

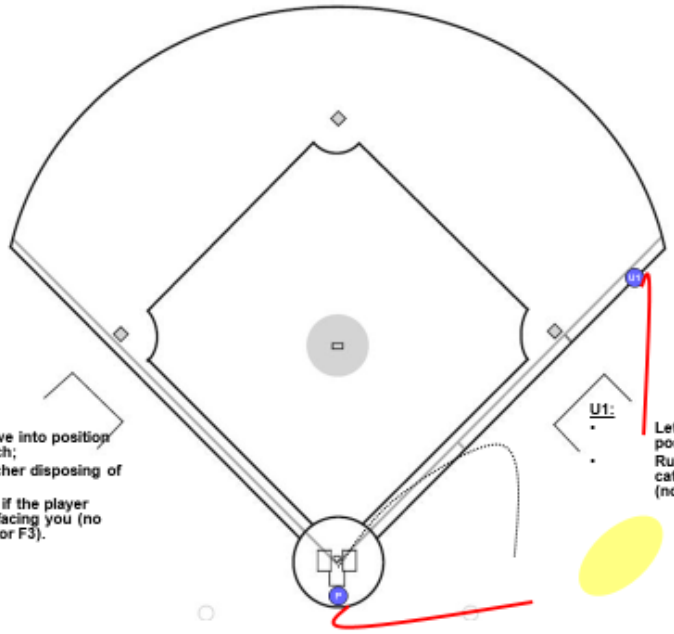


PLATE:

- Let F2 clear and move into position to rule catch/no catch;
- Be aware of the catcher disposing of his mask;
- Rule catch/no catch if the player catching the ball is facing you (no matter if it is the F2 or F3).

U1:

- Let F3 clear and move into position to rule catch/no catch;
- Rule catch/no catch if the player catching the ball is facing you (no matter if it is the F2 or F3).

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

BASE HIT

POSSIBLE TRIPLE

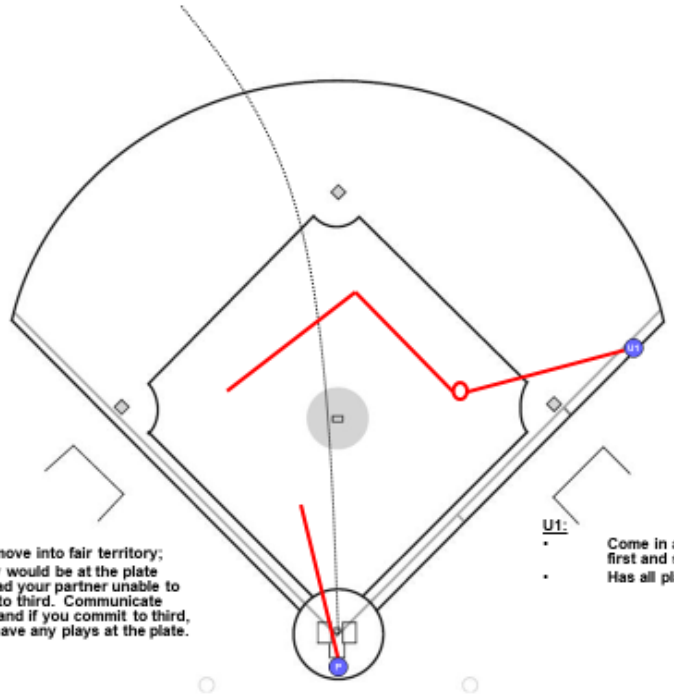


PLATE:

- Clear F2 and move into fair territory;
- Your next play would be at the plate unless you read your partner unable to take runner into third. Communicate your location and if you commit to third, you will also have any plays at the plate.

U1:

- Come in and pivot, watch touch of first and stay ahead of runner;
- Has all plays at 1st, 2nd and 3rd.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

GROUND BALL

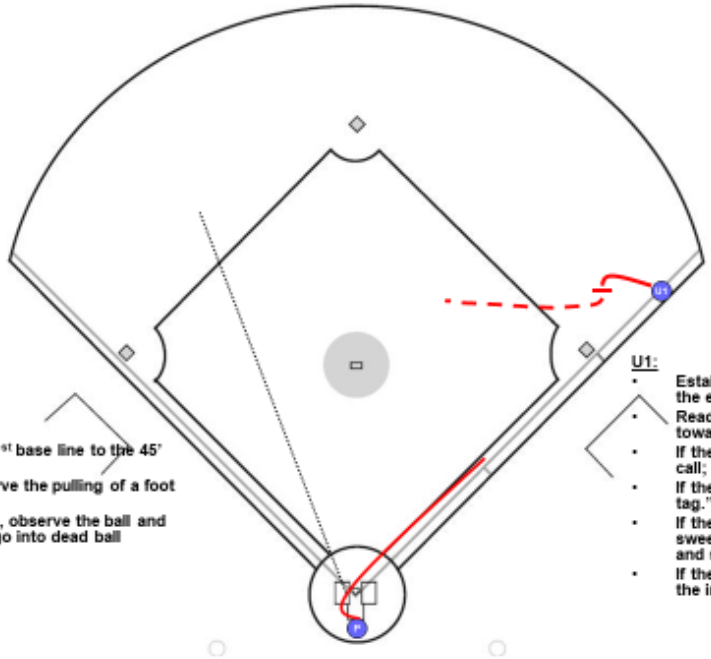


PLATE:

- Trail the BR up the 1st base line to the 45' line;
- Be stopped to observe the pulling of a foot or a swipe tag;
- If the ball gets by F3, observe the ball and be sure it does not go into dead ball territory.

U1:

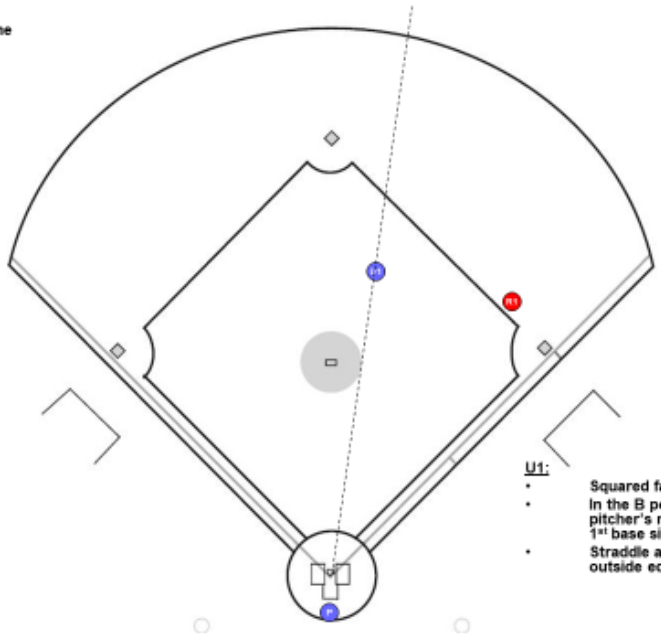
- Establish a 90 degree angle to the expected throw;
- Read the throw and then turn toward the base;
- If the play is close, "sell" the call;
- If there is a tag, say, "On the tag.";
- If the foot is pulled, give a sweeping motion with both arms and say, "Off the bag.";
- If the ball gets by F3, move into the infield avoiding the BR.

RUNNER ON FIRST

Communication:
Standard Rotation (S14)

Fair/Foul Responsibilities

- Plate – both lines to the foul poles.
- U1 – None



U1:

- Squared facing home plate;
- In the B position, halfway between the pitcher's mound and 2nd base, on the 1st base side of the infield;
- Straddle an imaginary line off the outside edge of the pitcher's mound.

FLY BALL/LINE DRIVE RESPONSIBILITIES
(Same for all situations with U1 inside)

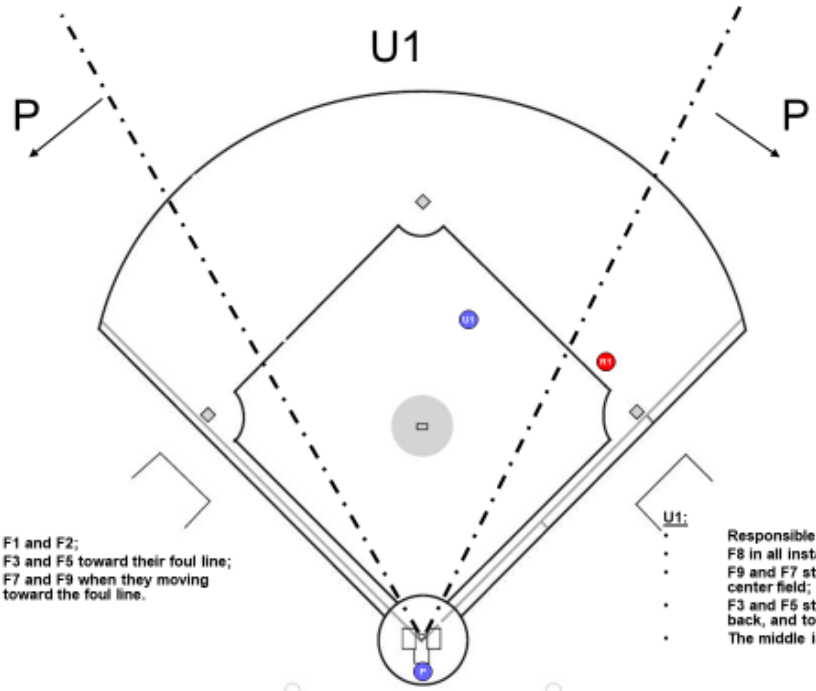


PLATE:
- F1 and F2;
- F3 and F5 toward their foul line;
- F7 and F9 when they moving toward the foul line.

U1:
- Responsible for the "V";
- F8 in all instances;
- F9 and F7 straight in and toward center field;
- F3 and F5 straight in, straight back, and toward the middle;
- The middle infielders.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL TO RF
U1 HAS THE CATCH/NO CATCH

Communication:
Plate, tell partner you're at 3rd if he comes

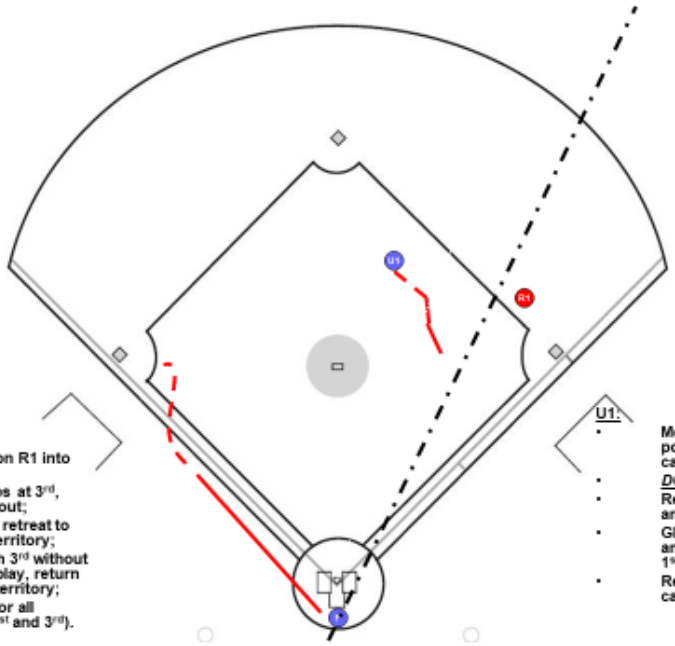


Plate:
- Has all plays on R1 into 3rd;
- If play develops at 3rd, move into cutout;
- On overthrow retreat to home in fair territory;
- If R1 will reach 3rd without any possible play, return home in foul territory;
- Responsible for all overthrows (1st and 3rd).

U1:
- Move to get the best angle possible to observe the catch/no catch;
- *DO NOT* cross the dirt;
- Responsible for all plays at 1st and 2nd;
- Glance at the BR's touch of 1st and react to take him back into 1st;
- Responsible for tag up on caught fly ball.

15

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL TO RF

U1 HAS THE CATCH/NO CATCH

Communication:
Plate, tell partner you're at 3rd if he comes

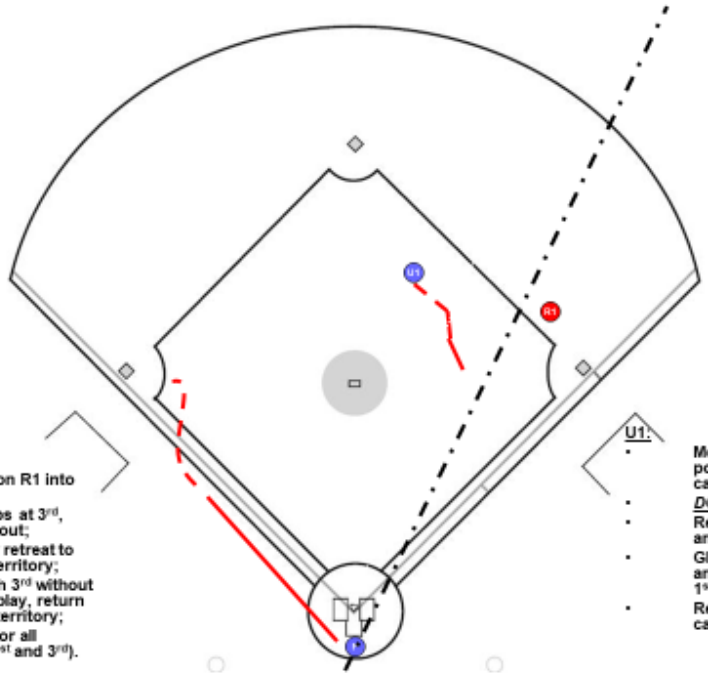


Plate:

- Has all plays on R1 into 3rd;
- If play develops at 3rd, move into cutout;
- On overthrow retreat to home in fair territory;
- If R1 will reach 3rd without any possible play, return home in foul territory;
- Responsible for all overthrows (1st and 3rd).

U1:

- Move to get the best angle possible to observe the catch/no catch;
- *DO NOT* cross the dirt;
- Responsible for all plays at 1st and 2nd;
- Glance at the BR's touch of 1st and react to take him back into 1st;
- Responsible for tag up on caught fly ball.

15

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL DOWN THE RF LINE

PLATE HAS THE FAIR/FOUL AND CATCH/NO CATCH

Communication:
Plate, tell partner you're on the ball, he has all bases.

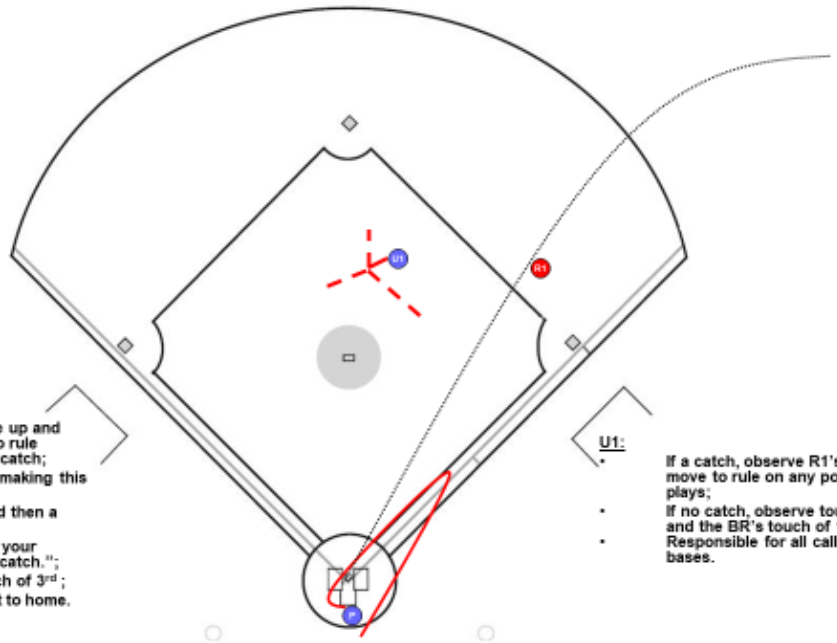


Plate:

- Clear F2 and move up and straddle the line to rule fair/foul, catch/no catch;
- Be stopped when making this call;
- Signal fair/foul and then a catch/no catch;
- When a catch, tell your partner, "That's a catch.";
- Observe R1's touch of 3rd ;
- If no catch, retreat to home.

U1:

- If a catch, observe R1's tag and move to rule on any possible plays;
- If no catch, observe touch of 2nd and the BR's touch of 1st;
- Responsible for all calls at all bases.

16

BASE HIT

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

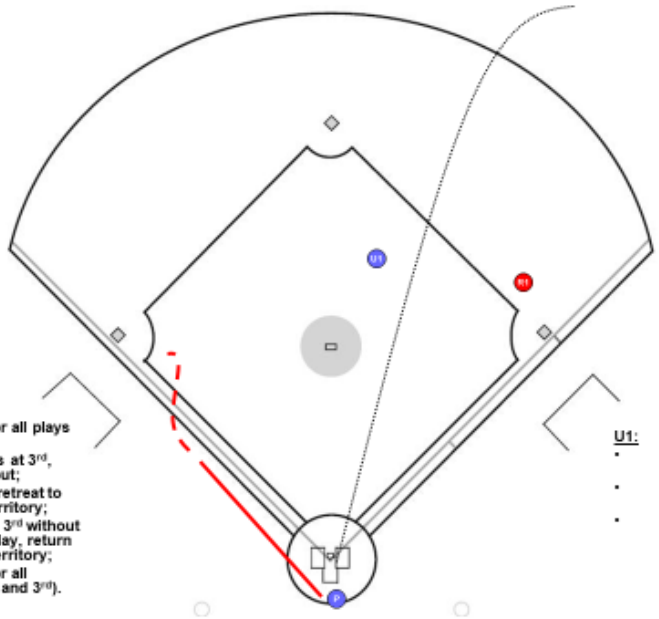


Plate:

- Responsible for all plays on R1 into 3rd;
- If play develops at 3rd, move into cutout;
- On overthrow retreat to home in fair territory;
- If R1 will reach 3rd without any possible play, return home in foul territory;
- Responsible for all overthrows(1st and 3rd).

U1:

- Responsible for all touches at 1st and 2nd;
- Split difference between 1st and 2nd;
- Make sure partner is rotating to third, and be prepared to cover all plays!

GROUND BALL

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

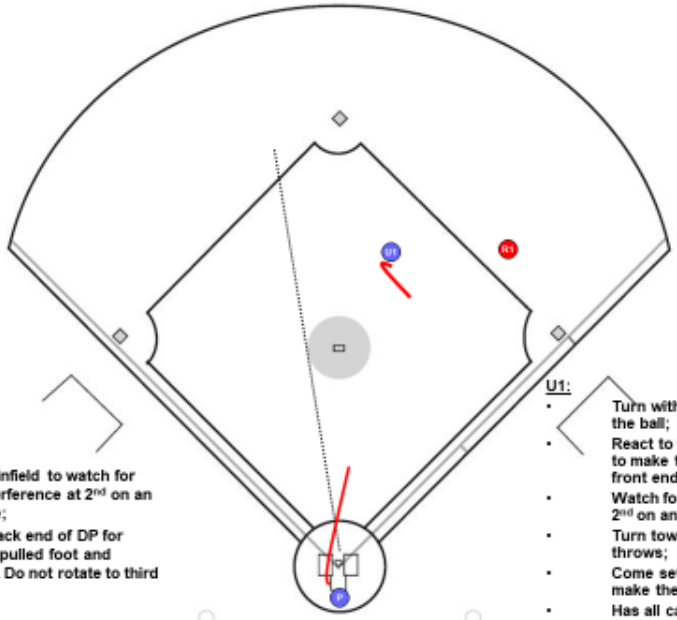


Plate:

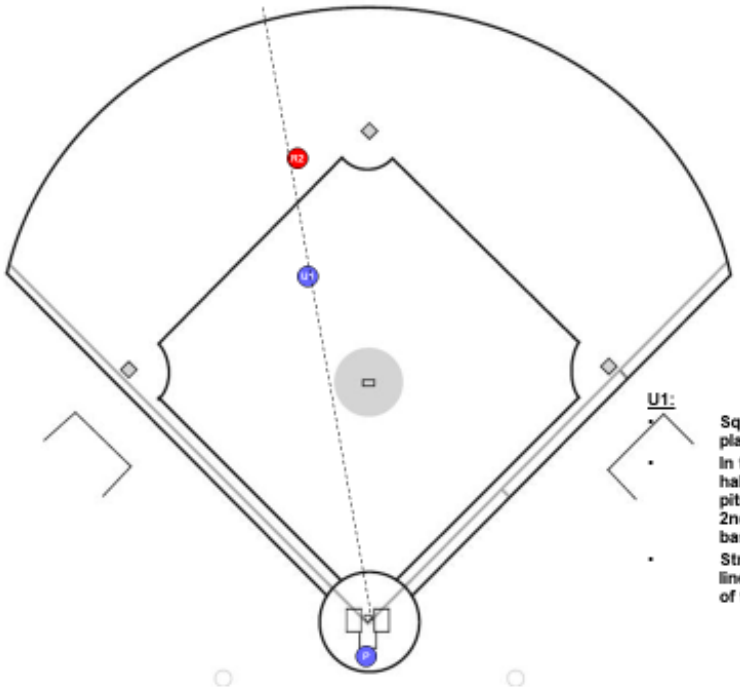
- Move into infield to watch for runner interference at 2nd on an illegal slide;
- Observe back end of DP for swipe tag, pulled foot and overthrow. Do not rotate to third base.

U1:

- Turn with the batted ball, facing the ball;
- React to the throw and line up to make the call at 2nd on the front end of the possible DP;
- Watch for runner interference at 2nd on an illegal slide;
- Turn toward 1st as the fielder throws;
- Come set, observe the play, make the call.
- Has all calls at 1st, 2nd and 3rd

RUNNER ON SECOND

Communication:
Staying Home (S16)
If two out also add Timing Play (S13)



U1:

- Squared facing home plate;
- In the C position, halfway between the pitcher's mound and 2nd base, on the 3rd base side of the infield;
- Straddle an imaginary line off the outside edge of the pitcher's mound.

INITIAL MOVEMENT
SECONDARY MOVEMENT
BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL TO OUTFIELD
R1 TAGS

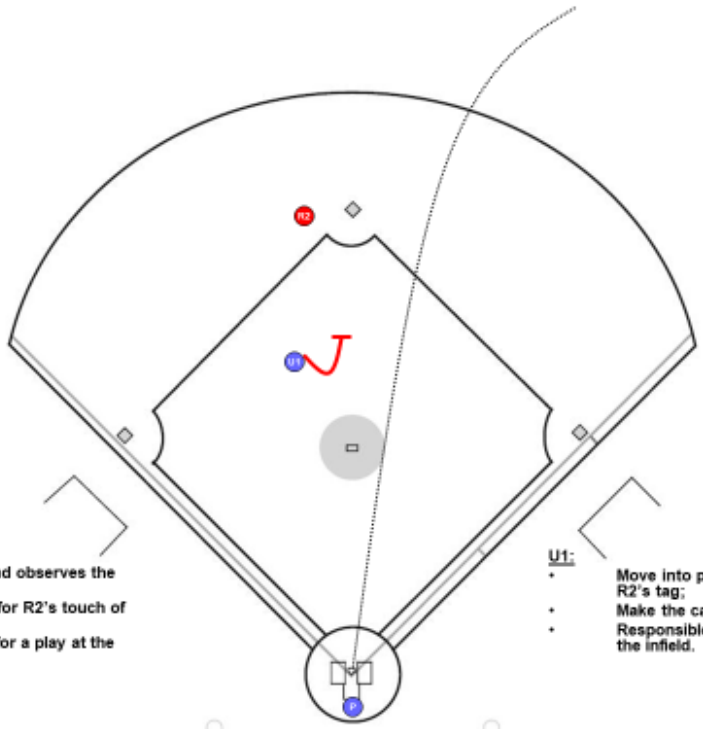


Plate:

- Stay home and observes the action;
- Responsible for R2's touch of 3rd;
- Be prepared for a play at the plate.

U1:

- Move into position to observe R2's tag;
- Make the catch/no catch call;
- Responsible for all plays in the infield.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

BASE HIT

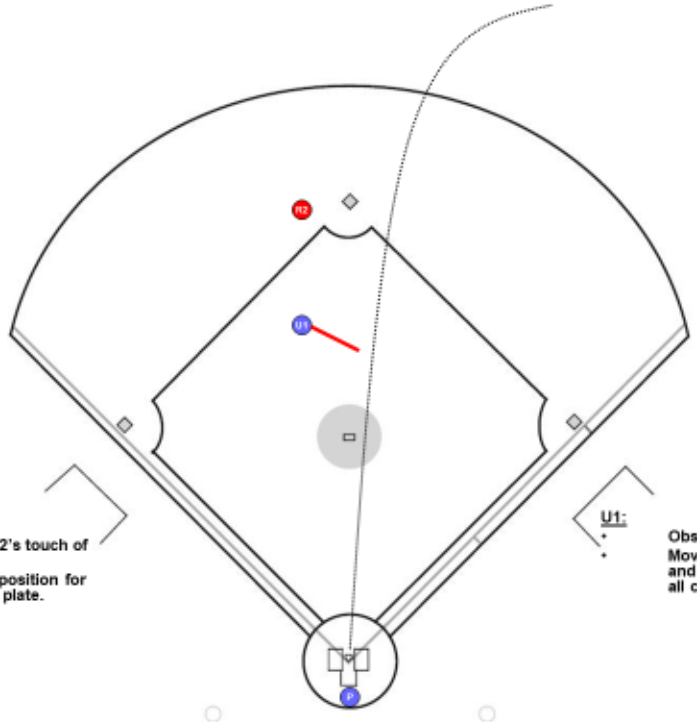


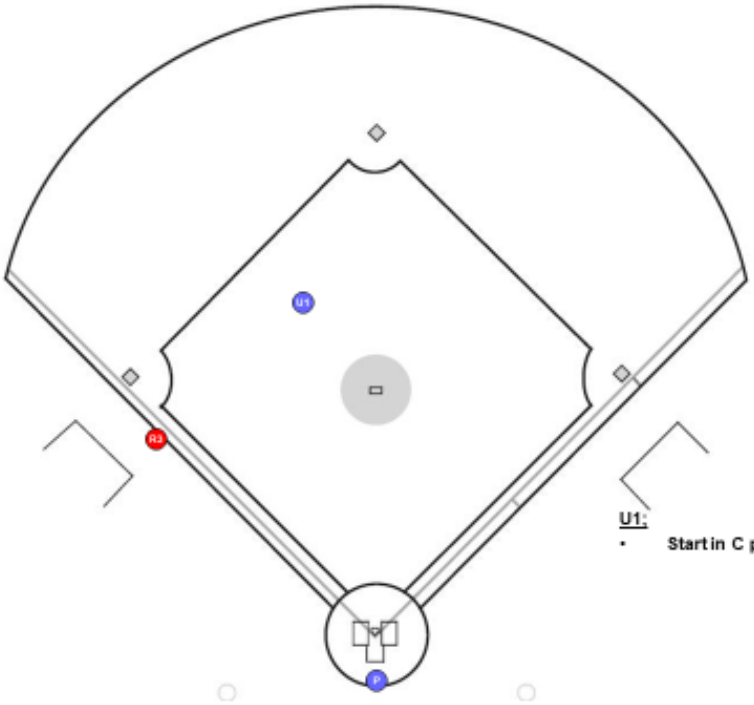
Plate:

- Observe R2's touch of 3rd;
- Move into position for play at the plate.

U1:

- Observe BR's touch of 1st;
- Move into working area and be prepared to make all calls at all bases.

RUNNER AT THIRD



U1:

- Start in C position

FLY BALL TO OUTFIELD

U1 HAS THE CATCH/NO CATCH

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

Communication:
Staying home (16)

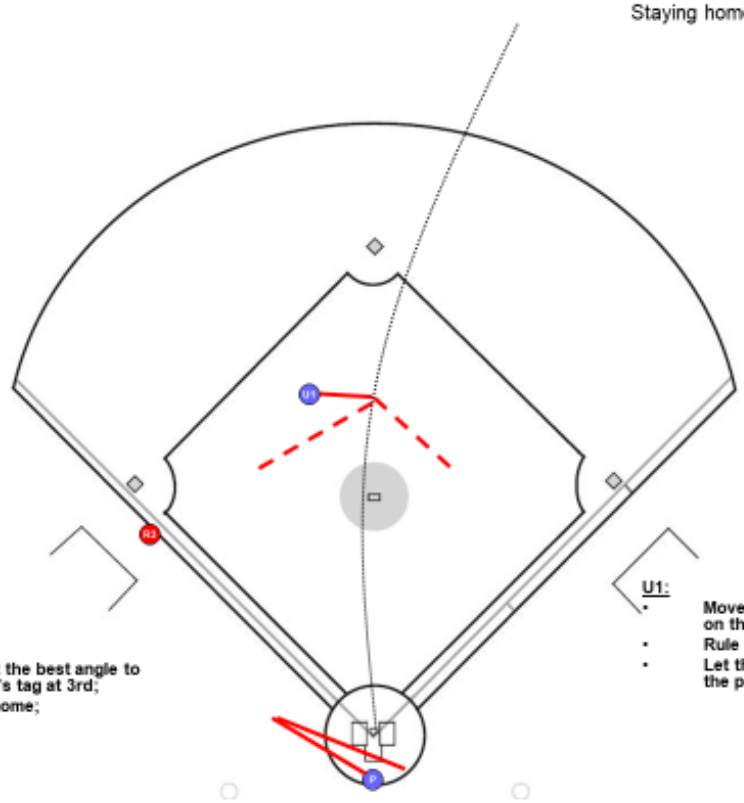


Plate:

- Move to get the best angle to observe R3's tag at 3rd;
- Retreat to home;

U1:

- Move into position to rule on the catch/no catch;
- Rule catch/no catch;
- Let the throw take you to the play.

FLY BALL DOWN THE RF LINE

PLATE HAS THE FAIR/FOUL AND CATCH/NO CATCH
RUNNER TAGS

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

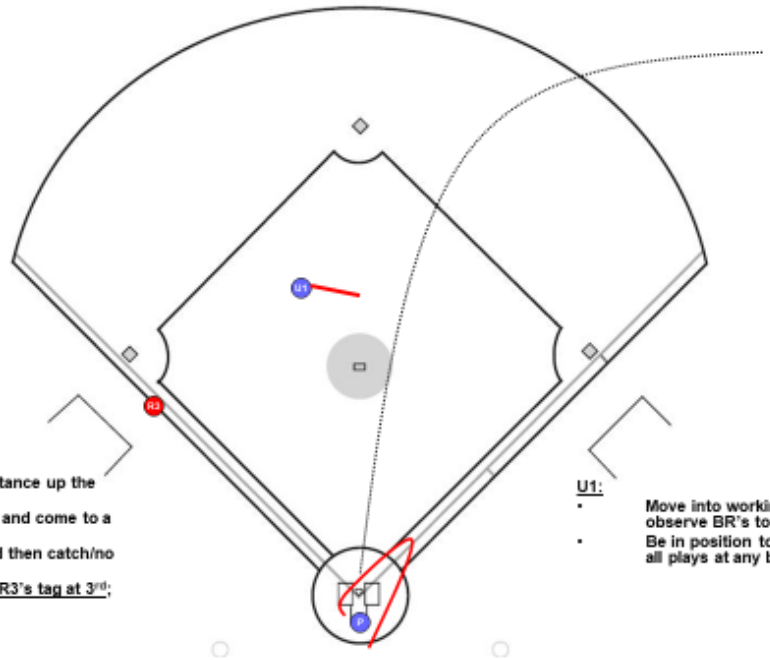


Plate:

- Move a short distance up the baseline;
- Straddle the line and come to a complete stop;
- Rule fair/foul and then catch/no catch;
- Responsible for R3's tag at 3rd;
- Retreat to home.

U1:

- Move into working area to observe BR's touch at 1st;
- Be in position to react to all plays at any bases.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

BASE HIT

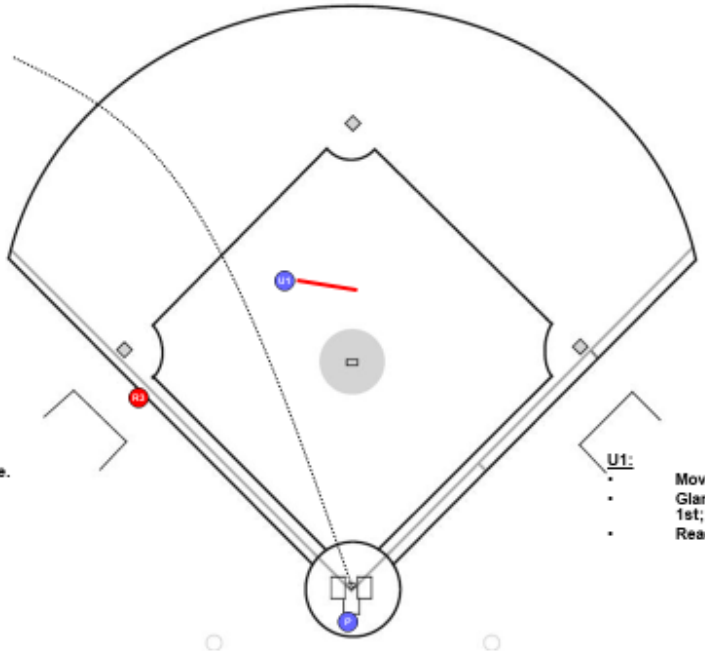


Plate:

- Stays home.

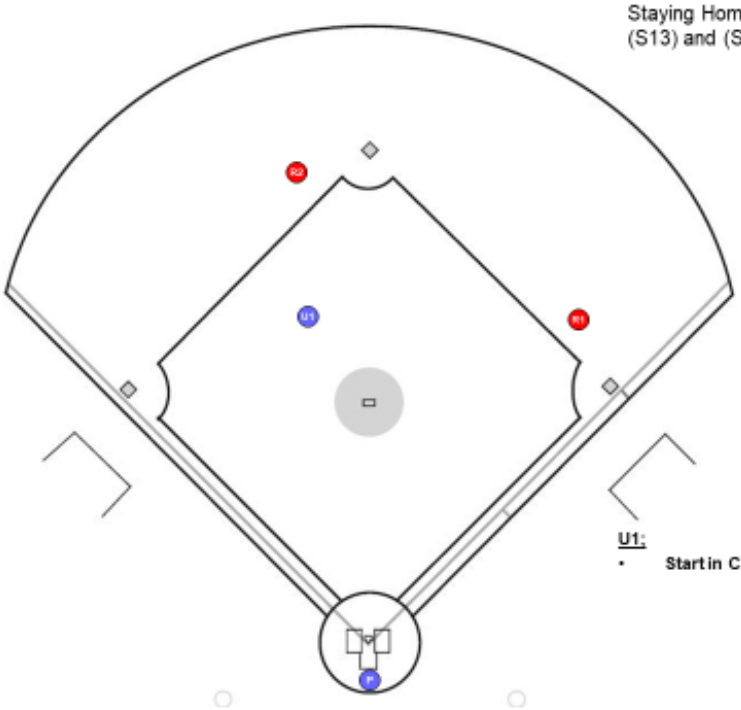
U1:

- Move into working area;
- Glance at BR's touch of 1st;
- React to the throw.

RUNNERS AT FIRST AND SECOND

Communication:

Less than 2 outs:
Infield fly, plate covers third on caught fly ball to outfield (15)
Two outs:
Staying Home and timing play (S13) and (S16)



U1:

- Start in C position

ROUTINE FLY BALL

U1 HAS THE CATCH/NO CATCH
R1 TAGS

INITIAL MOVEMENT
SECONDARY MOVEMENT
BALL FLIGHT

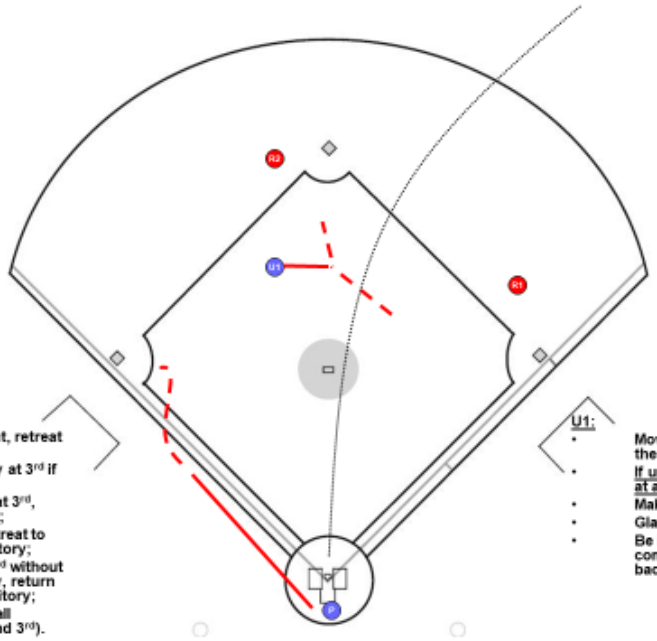


Plate:

- If fly is not caught, retreat home;
- If caught, has play at 3rd if R2 tags;
- If play develops at 3rd, move into cutout;
- On overthrow retreat to home in fair territory;
- If R2 will reach 3rd without any possible play, return home in foul territory;
- Responsible for all overthrows(1st and 3rd).

U1:

- Move into position to rule on the catch/no catch;
- If uncaught, you have all plays at all bases;
- Make the catch/no catch call;
- Glance at R2 and R1's tag ups;
- Be in position to react to R2 coming back into 2nd and R1 back into 1st or on to 2nd.

FLY BALL DOWN THE RF LINE

PLATE HAS THE FAIR/FOUL AND CATCH/NO CATCH
R1 TAGS

INITIAL MOVEMENT
SECONDARY MOVEMENT
BALL FLIGHT

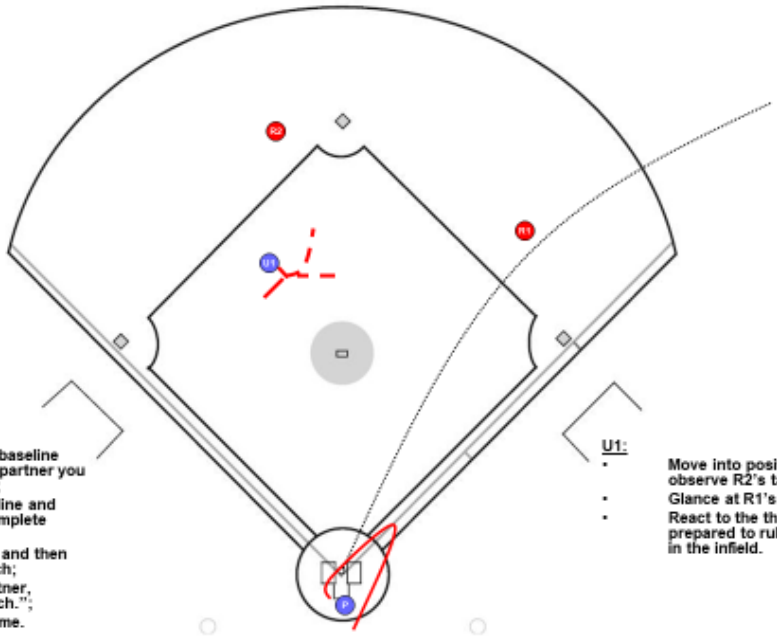


Plate:

- Move up the baseline and tell your partner you have the ball;
- Straddle the line and come to a complete stop;
- Rule fair/foul and then catch/no catch;
- Tell your partner, "That's a catch.";
- Retreat to home.

U1:

- Move into position to observe R2's tag at 2nd;
- Glance at R1's tag at 1st;
- React to the throw and be prepared to rule on all plays in the infield.

BASE HIT

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

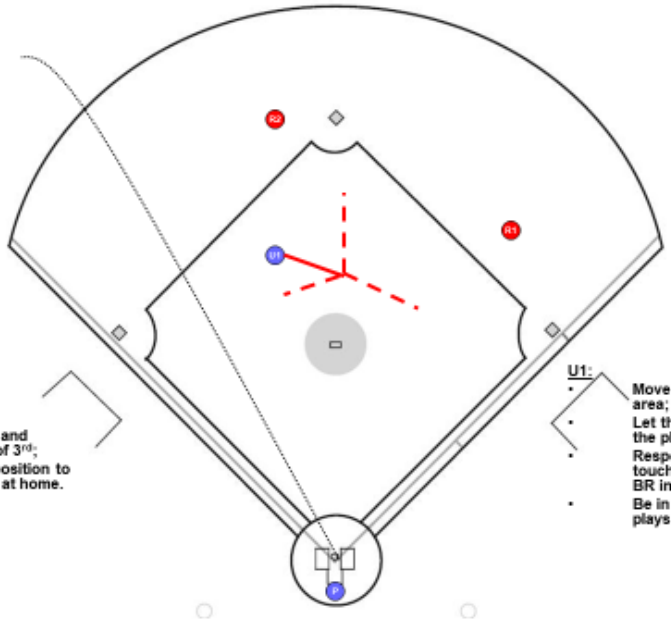


Plate:

- Observe R2 and R1's touch of 3rd;
- Move into position to rule on play at home.

U1:

- Move into the working area;
- Let the throw take you to the play;
- Responsible for all touches of 1st and 2nd and BR into third;
- Be in position to take all plays in the infield.

GROUND BALL

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

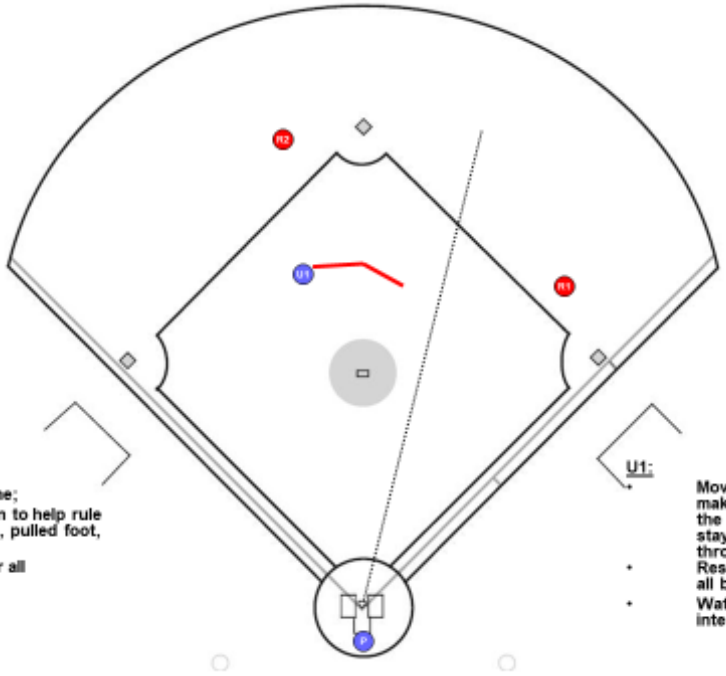


Plate:

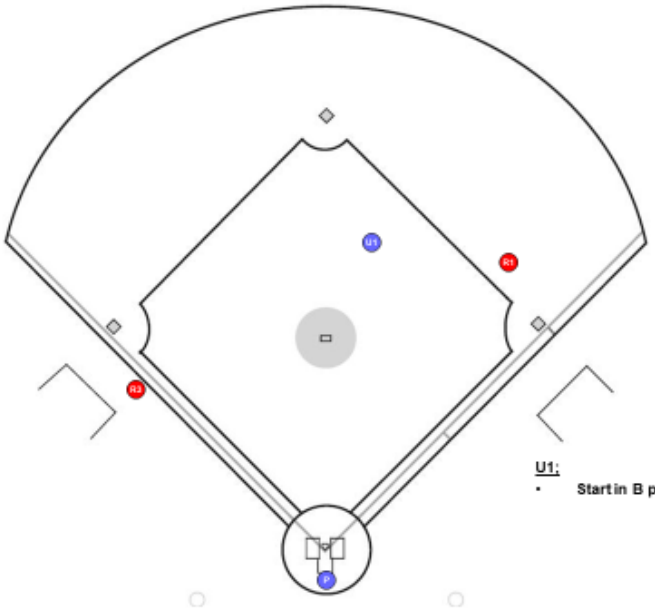
- Plate stays home;
- Observes action to help rule on illegal slides, pulled foot, swipe tags;
- Responsible for all overthrows.

U1:

- Move into a position to make a call at any base in the infield being careful to stay out of the line of the throw;
- Responsible for all calls at all bases;
- Watch for runner interference.

RUNNERS AT FIRST AND THIRD

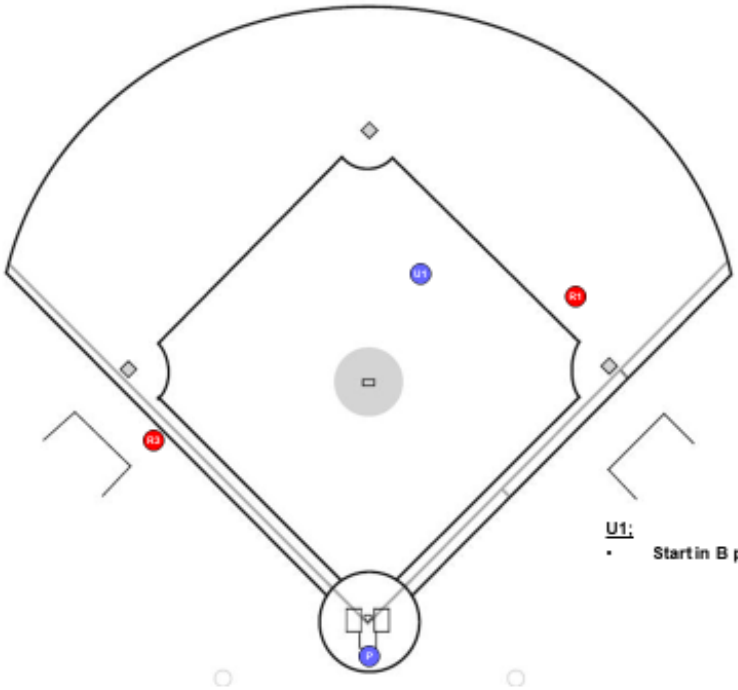
Communication:
Standard Rotation (S14) on base hit into outfield



U1:
- **Start in B position**

RUNNERS AT FIRST AND THIRD

Communication:
Standard Rotation (S14) on base hit into outfield



U1:
- **Start in B position**

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

FLY BALL DOWN THE RF LINE

PLATE HAS FAIR/FOUL AND CATCH/NO CATCH

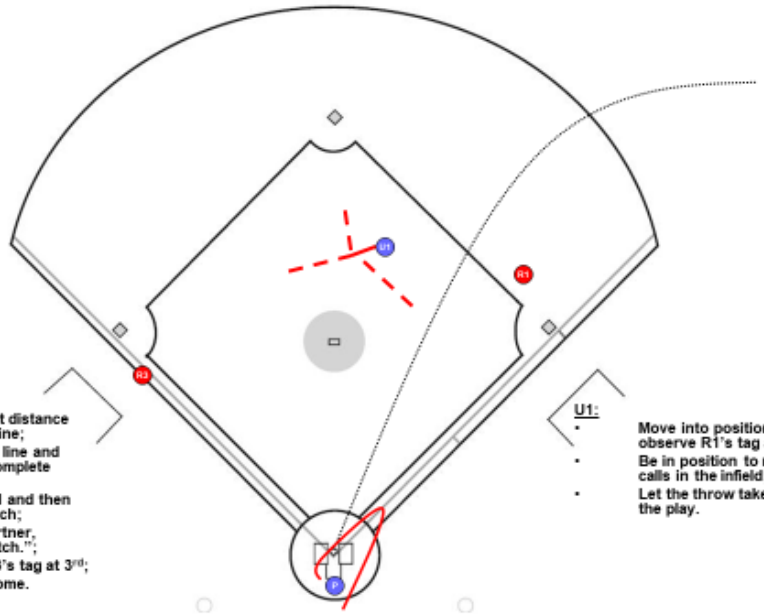


Plate:

- Move a short distance up the baseline;
- Straddle the line and come to a complete stop;
- Rule fair/foul and then catch/no catch;
- Tell your partner, "That's a catch.";
- Glance at R3's tag at 3rd;
- Retreat to home.

U1:

- Move into position to observe R1's tag at 1st;
- Be in position to make all calls in the infield;
- Let the throw take you to the play.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

BASE HIT

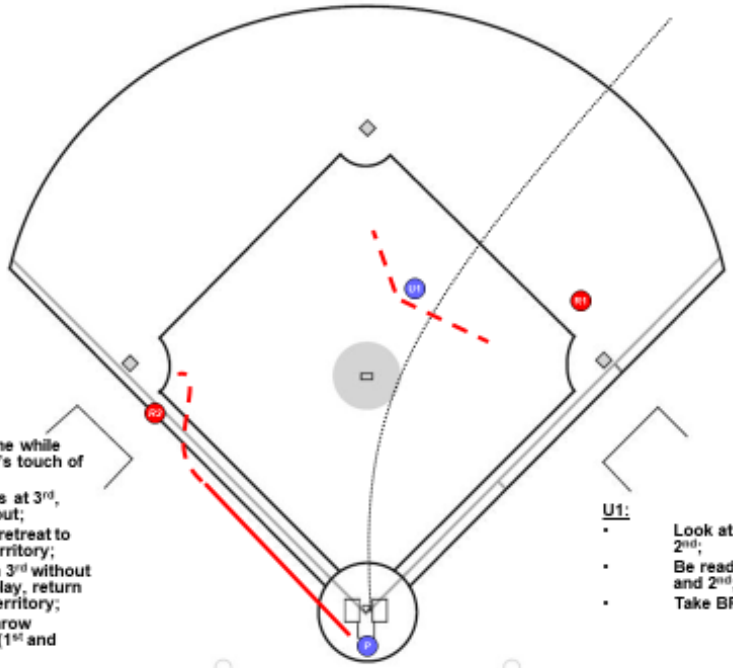


Plate:

- Move up the line while glancing at R3's touch of home;
- If play develops at 3rd, move into cutout;
- On overthrow retreat to home in fair territory;
- If R1 will reach 3rd without any possible play, return home in foul territory;
- Take all overthrow responsibility (1st and 3rd).

U1:

- Look at all touches of 1st and 2nd;
- Be ready to make all calls at 1st and 2nd;
- Take BR into 3rd on triple.

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

GROUND BALL

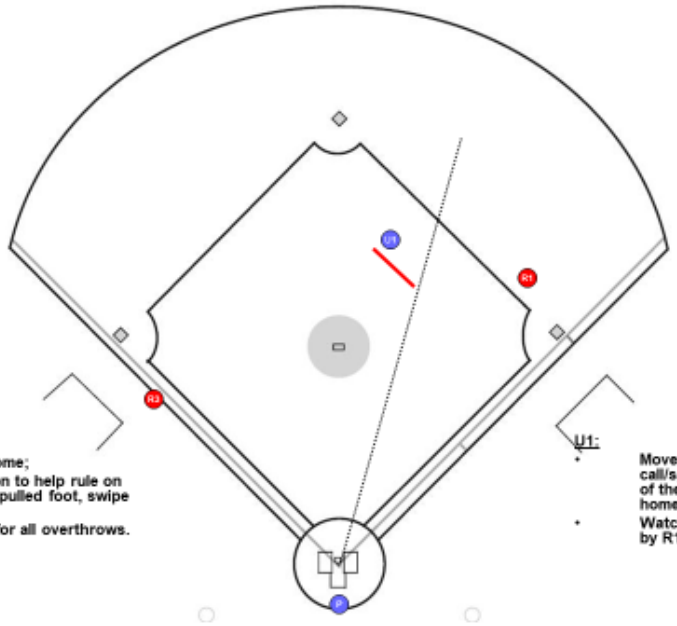


Plate:

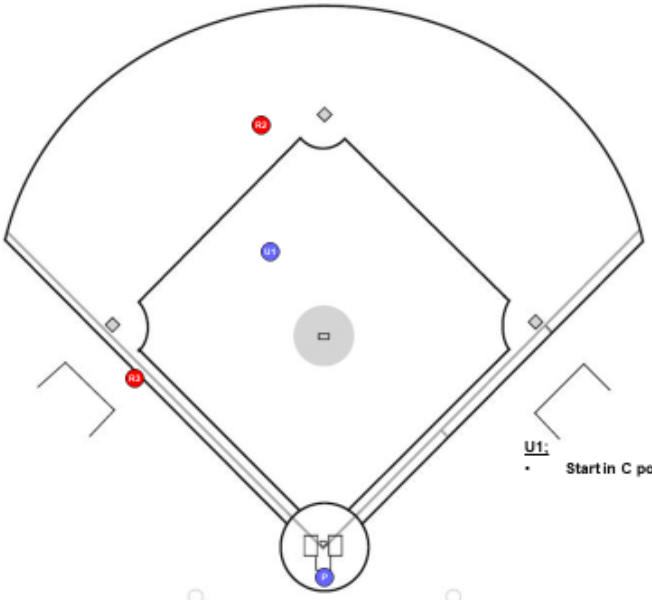
- Plate stays home;
- Observe action to help rule on Illegal slides, pulled foot, swipe tags;
- Responsible for all overthrows.

U1:

- Move into position to make the call/s, being careful to stay out of the line of a possible throw home;
- Watch for runner interference by R1.

RUNNERS AT SECOND AND THIRD

Communication:
Staying Home (S16)
With two outs also add
Timing Play (S13)



U1:

- Start in C position

ROUTINE FLY BALL

U1 HAS THE CATCH/NO CATCH
RUNNER TAGS

INITIAL MOVEMENT
SECONDARY MOVEMENT
BALL FLIGHT

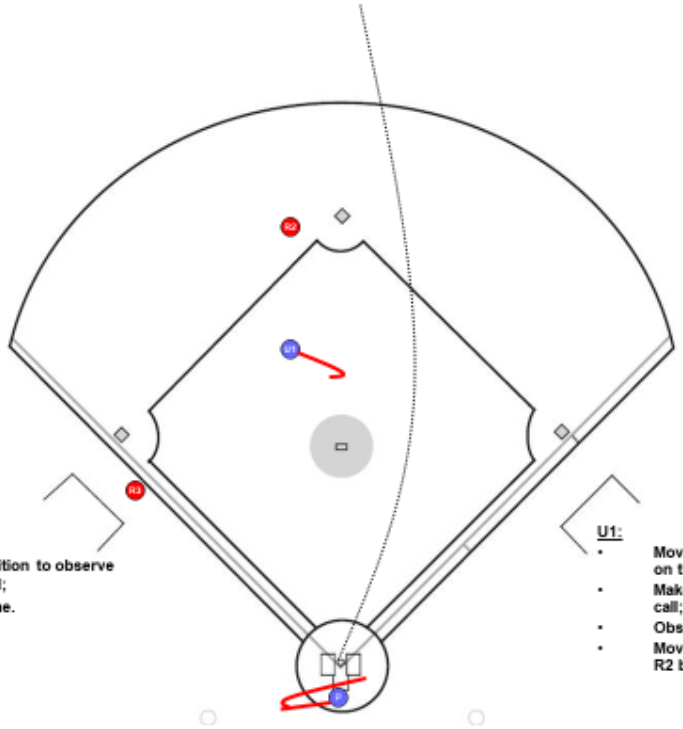


Plate:

- Move into position to observe R3's tag at 3rd;
- Retreat to home.

U1:

- Move into position to rule on the catch/no catch;
- Make the catch/no catch call;
- Observe R2's tag at 2nd;
- Move into position to take R2 back into 2nd or into 3rd.

BASE HIT

INITIAL MOVEMENT
SECONDARY MOVEMENT
BALL FLIGHT

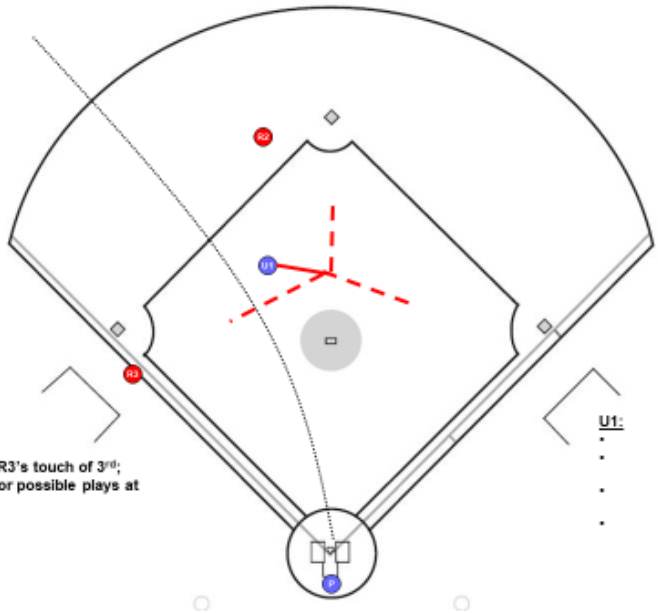


Plate:

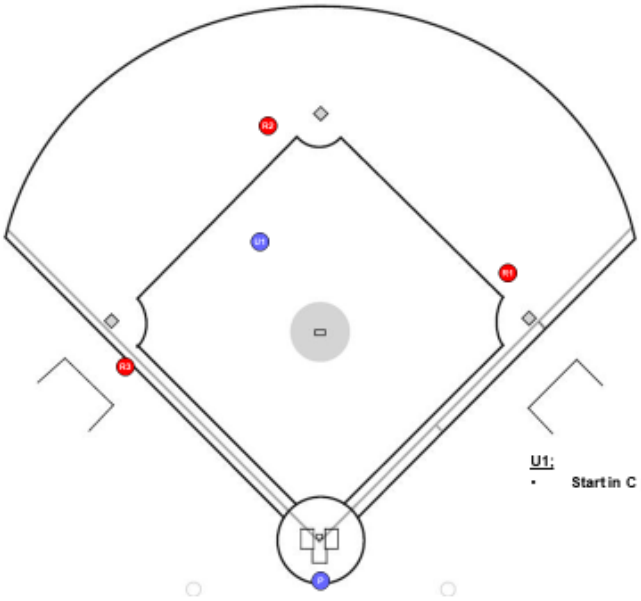
- Glance at R3's touch of 3rd;
- Be ready for possible plays at the plate.

U1:

- Move into working area;
- Glance at BR's touch of 1st;
- Be alert to take plays at all bases in the infield;
- Let the throw take you to the play.

BASES LOADED

Communication:
Staying Home (S16)
With two outs also add
Timing Play (S13)



U1:
- **Start in C position**

ROUTINE FLY BALL
U1 HAS THE CATCH/NO CATCH

INITIAL MOVEMENT
SECONDARY MOVEMENT
BALL FLIGHT

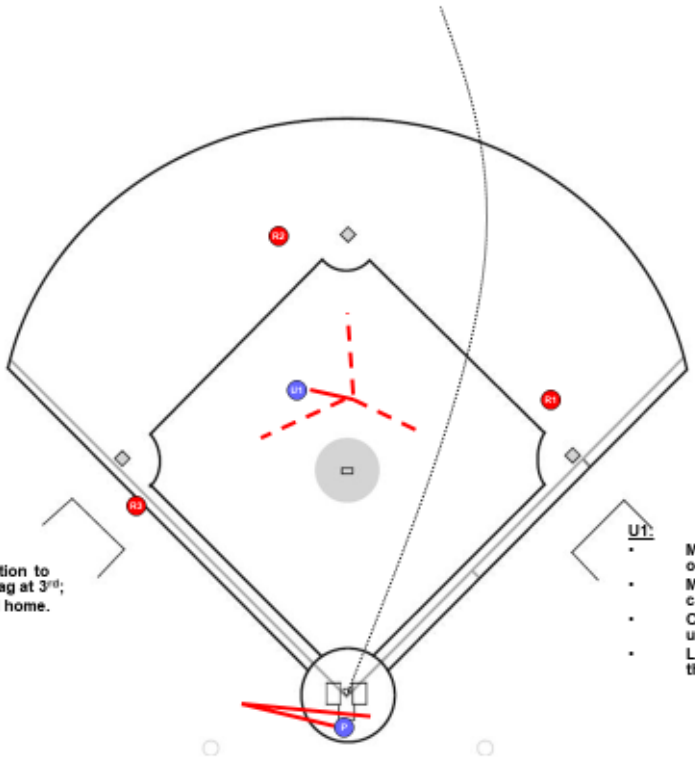


Plate:
- **Move into position to observe R3's tag at 3rd;**
- **Retreat toward home.**

U1:
- **Move into position to rule on the catch;**
- **Make the catch/no catch call;**
- **Observe R2's and R1's tag ups;**
- **Let the throw take you to the play.**

INITIAL MOVEMENT

SECONDARY MOVEMENT

BALL FLIGHT

BASE HIT

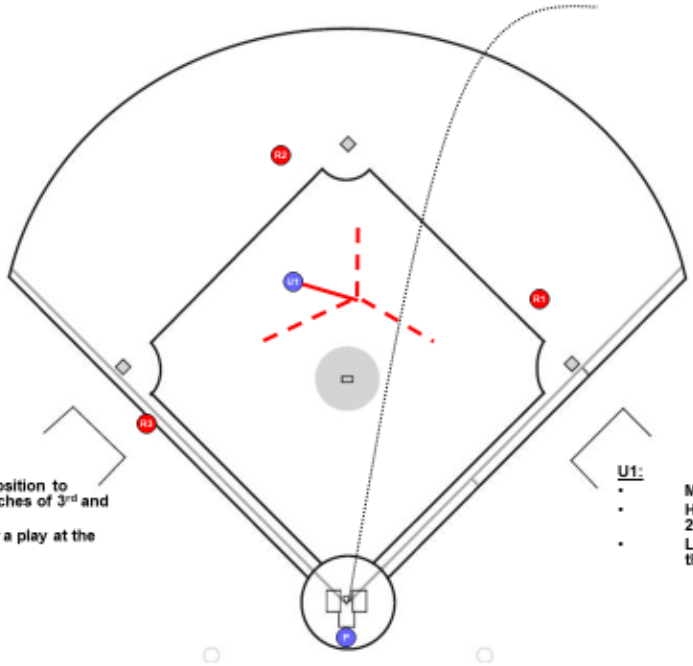


Plate:

- Move into position to observe touches of 3rd and home;
- Be ready for a play at the plate.

U1:

- Move into working area;
- Has all touches at 1st and 2nd;
- Let the throw take you to the play.